



STRATEGY & OPERATIONS · SAMPLE DELIVERABLE

Operating Priorities — Three 28-Day Cycles

The one-page operating plan I deliver at the start of a fractional-COO or strategy engagement: what we focus on first, what we build next, and what compounds by the end of the third cycle. (Illustrative, for a fictional growing services business.)

CYCLE 1
Days 1–28

Diagnose & stabilize

- Map how work actually flows; find the bottlenecks.
- Stand up one source of truth for pipeline and cash.
- Quick wins: kill 2–3 low-value recurring tasks.
- Agree the 3 metrics that define the next quarter.

CYCLE 2
Days 29–56

Build the systems

- Document the core process; assign clear owners.
- Put a lightweight dashboard in front of the team.
- Fix the highest-friction handoff end-to-end.
- Set hiring/capacity plan against demand.

CYCLE 3
Days 57–84

Scale what works

- Systematize the wins into repeatable playbooks.
- Shift from firefighting to a weekly operating rhythm.
- Hand off owners so it runs without me.
- Board-ready snapshot: results, metrics, next bets.

The point isn't the plan on paper — it's that by the end of Cycle 3 (day 84) the business runs on systems and a rhythm, not on heroics.